



MEMORANDUM

To: Governing Body, City of Cheyenne

FROM: Renee Smith, Economic Resource Administrator

DATE: November 4, 2025

SUBJECT: Resolution to support a Wyoming Business Council Business Ready Community grant application to purchase land for affordable housing.

SUMMARY:

The City submitted a Wyoming Business Council Business Ready Community Readiness grant for the purchase of 8.37 acres of land that sits on the northwest corner of Carlson Street and Converse Avenue. This land acquisition project is phase one of a planned 184-rental property developed by Kamaka Responsible Development, LLC and financed with 4% tax credits and tax-exempt bonds. First & Union (the "Community") will consist of eight, three-story buildings consisting of 46 one-bedroom units, 92 two-bedroom units and 46 three-bedroom units. The Community will house families who earn 60% of the area's median income, which equates to \$41,760 to \$58,580 in annual income from a single person household to a family of four.

In an effort to help Kamaka overcome their financing gap and to keep housing rents affordable, the City of Cheyenne is requesting \$2,175,000 from the BRC program to purchase land and lease back to the affordable community (First & Union) through a lease agreement. The purchase price is \$2.9M. WBC requires a 25% match, and the City has requested to use \$500,000 in Housing & Urban Development Community Development Block Grant funds and another \$225,000 in Related Digital funds recently gifted to the city for the purpose of creating more affordable housing units. These funds will be used to maximize the donation from Related Digital to include an additional housing project. Recaptured revenue will be used for future development opportunities.

Contact Renee Smith at rsmith@cheyennecity.org or 307-637-6285 for more information.

RESOLUTION NO. _____

ENTITLED: “A RESOLUTION AUTHORIZING THE SUBMISSION OF AN APPLICATION TO THE WYOMING BUSINESS COUNCIL UNDER THE BUSINESS READY COMMUNITY GRANT AND LOAN PROGRAM ON BEHALF OF THE CITY OF CHEYENNE FOR A COMMUNITY READINESS GRANT FOR THE PURPOSE OF PURCHASING 8.37 ACRES OF LAND FOR THE DEVELOPMENT OF AFFORDABLE HOUSING.”

WHEREAS, the Governing Body of the City of Cheyenne desires to participate in the Business Ready Community Grant and Loan Program to assist in financing an affordable housing development project (the “First & Main Project”);

WHEREAS, the Governing Body recognizes that Cheyenne and Laramie County face significant barriers to regional economic growth due to a critical shortage of affordable housing inventory;

WHEREAS, the public benefits of this project will be realized through the purchase of land for an affordable housing development. Affordable housing promotes economic stability, better health outcomes, and stronger communities through increased job opportunities, improved financial security, and greater civic engagement;

WHEREAS, Stable homes help families thrive, reduce health risks, and support local economies while enhancing neighborhood resilience for everyone.

WHEREAS, the specific objective of this project is the purchase of 8.37 acres of land to facilitate the development of affordable housing, which will then enable the development of 184 affordable housing units, advancing community housing goals and meeting project timeline benchmarks;

WHEREAS, the Business Ready Community Grant and Loan Program requires that certain criteria be met, as described in the Wyoming Business Council’s program rules, and to the best of City’s knowledge, this application satisfies those criteria;

WHEREAS, the required local match, totaling seven hundred twenty-five thousand dollars (\$725,000.00), shall be provided from the City of Cheyenne’s Housing and Urban Development Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) funds in the amount of five hundred thousand dollars (\$500,000.00), and from Related Digital funds designated for affordable housing in the amount of two hundred twenty-five thousand dollars (225,000.00);

WHEREAS, the Governing Body intends that any revenue recaptured from this project shall be dedicated to future affordable housing development efforts;

WHEREAS, in the event of any project cost overruns, the City of Cheyenne shall provide the additional funding necessary to complete the project, utilizing grant funds from Related Digital;

WHEREAS, the Governing Body has considered other potential funding sources for this project, including grants or loans from the U.S. Department of Treasury under the American Rescue Plan Act, the U.S. Department Housing and Urban Development, the Wyoming Community Development Authority, and the Office of State Lands and Investment Capital Construction Loans;

WHEREAS, the City of Cheyenne is undertaking this project in partnership with Kamaka Responsible Development, LLC; and

WHEREAS, the City of Cheyenne held a public hearing on October 31, 2025, to solicit public comment on the proposed project and gave full and fair consideration to all comments received.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE GOVERNING BODY OF THE CITY OF CHEYENNE, WYOMING, that City staff are hereby authorized to submit a grant application for consideration of assistance in funding the First & Main Project in the amount of two million one hundred seventy-five thousand dollars (\$2,175,000.00) to the Wyoming Business Council; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that Patrick J. Collins, Mayor, is hereby designated as the authorized representative to act on behalf of the Governing Body on all matters relating to this grant application.

PRESENTED, READ AND ADOPTED THIS _____ DAY OF _____, 2025.

Patrick Collins, Mayor

(SEAL)

ATTEST:

Kylie Soden, City Clerk